Balance and Swap: home practice answers

Name _____ **Date** _____

For grown-ups. Please let your child try first, then check together. Ask *how do you know?* If your child is stuck, wait 10 seconds, then suggest drawing it.

1. 4
6 + 3 is 9, and 5 + 4 is 9. The 6 became 5 (1 less), so the 3 becomes 4 (1 more).

2. 5
10 went down by 1 to 9, so 4 goes up by 1 to 5. Both sides make 14.

3. 10
20 went up by 20 to 40, so 30 goes down by 20 to 10. Both sides make 50.

4. Yes. 36 went down by 2 to 34 and 14 went up by 2 to 16. Both make 50.
One number goes down by 2 and the other goes up by 2, so the total stays the same.

5. Any list that shows the first number going down by 1 and the second going up by 1, for example 7 + 5, 6 + 6, 5 + 7, 4 + 8, 3 + 9, 2 + 10, 1 + 11, 0 + 12.
Each time one thing moves across, the total stays 12. A grown-up can count the things on both piles to check.

More practice online (no timers, no scores): ask your tutor for the practice link.